

# Conformity and Compliance

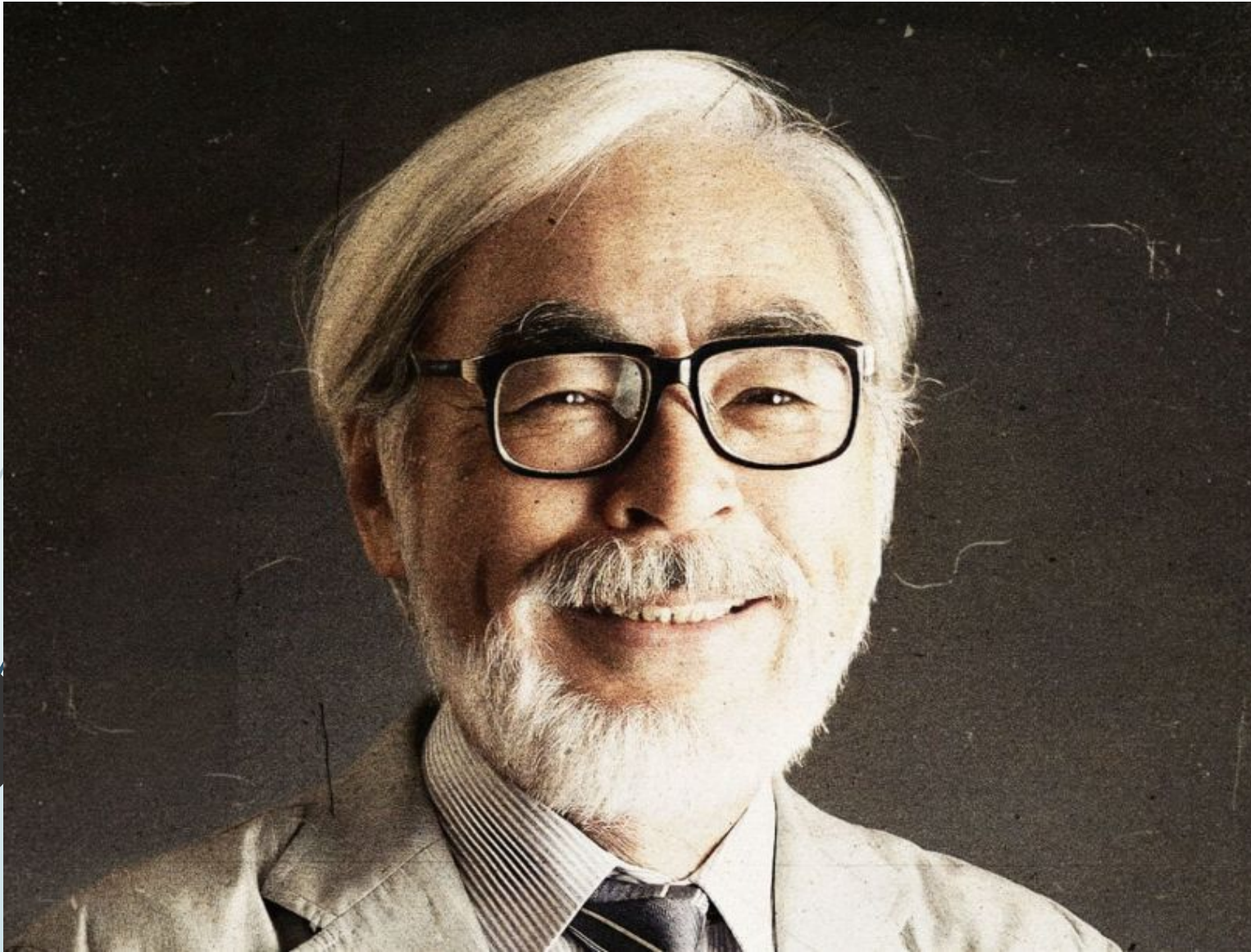


Image source:  
<https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/>



Image source:  
<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/etimes/trending/what-is-ghibli-and-why-did-chatgpts-ghibli-studio-suddenly-become-so-popular/articleshow/119713293.cms>



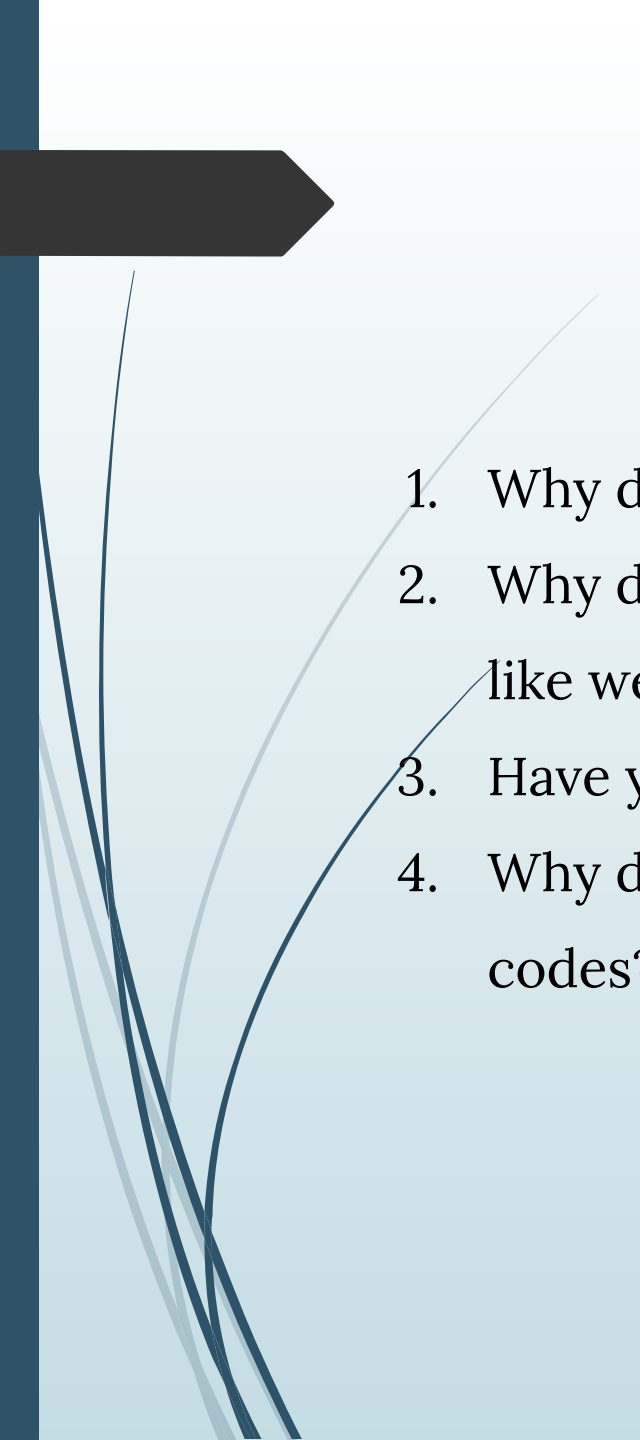


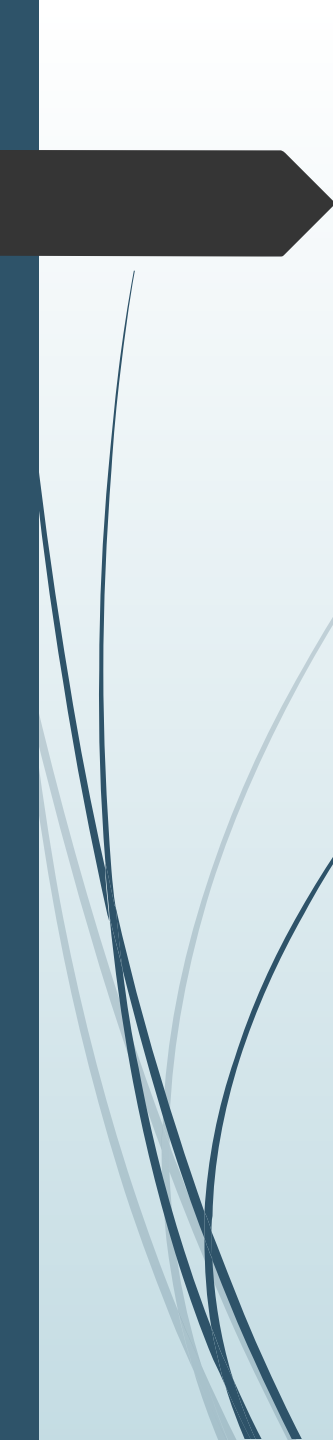
<https://supplychaindigital.com/digital-supply-chain/the-boom-of-la-bubu-can-supply-meet-consumer-demand>



Image  
source:<https://www.healthshots.com/healthy-eating/nutrition/avocado/>



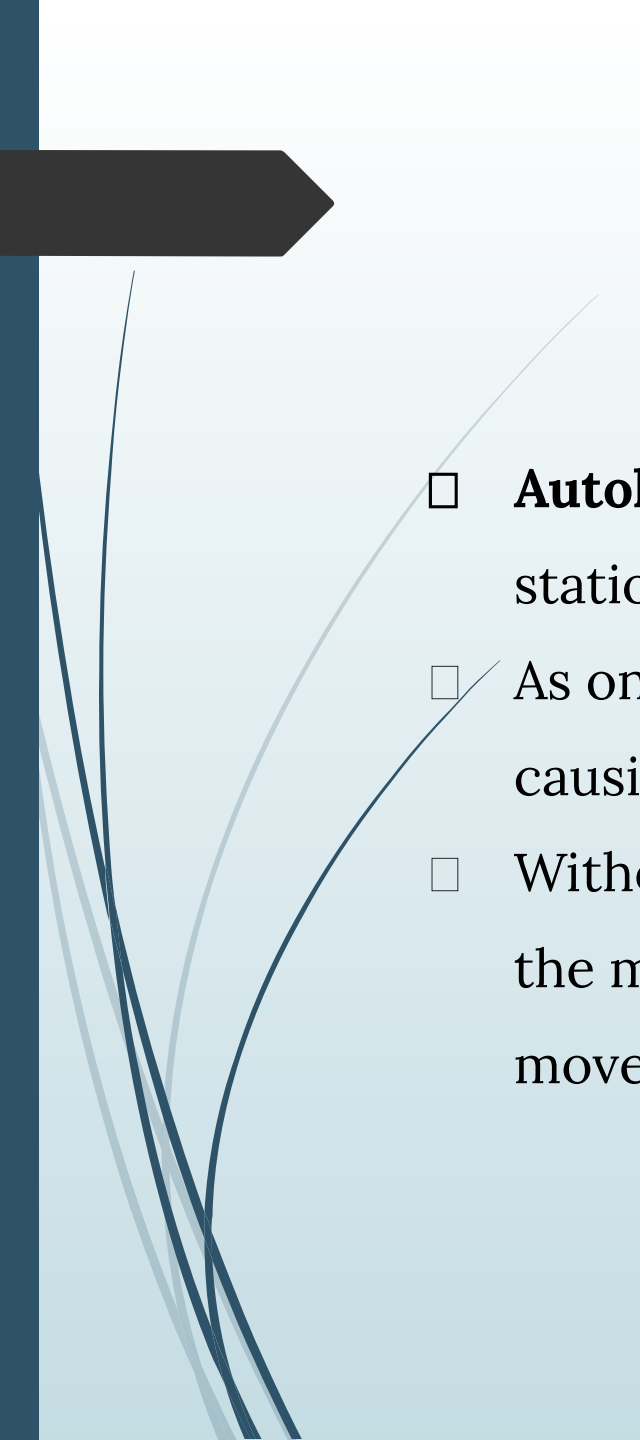
- 
1. Why do we all professionals have a similar kind of dressing?
  2. Why do you often wear a blazer for a formal meeting even when you don't like wearing blazer?
  3. Have you ever done something just because everyone else does it?
  4. Why do we follow dress codes even when there is no clear mention of dress codes?



# Conformity

- ☐ The tendency to change one's beliefs or behaviours to match the behaviour of others.
- ☐ In 1992, justice Anthony M Kennedy ruled a decision that public schools may not include prayers or invoke the name of God in public ceremony.
- ☐ school children are a captive audience and acutely sensitive to peer pressure.
- ☐ court must protect children's freedom of conscience from subtle coercive pressures in school.



- 
- ❑ **Autokinetic effect**, illusory movement of a single still object, usually a stationary pinpoint of light used in psychology experiments in dark rooms.
  - ❑ As one stares at a fixed point of light, one's eye muscles become fatigued, causing a slight eye movement.
  - ❑ Without the usual reference points available in the everyday environment, the movement of the image on the retina is perceived as its actual movement in space.

# Muzafer Sherif's experiment

- ❑ First Sherif studied how people reacted to the autokinetic effect when they were alone in the room.
- ❑ the light was moving between 2 to 6 inches, and they became consistent in making this judgment from trial to trial.
- ❑ Next *groups* of subjects were put in the dark room, 2 or 3 at a time, and asked to agree on a judgment. Now Sherif noted a tendency to compromise.
- ❑ the participants were asked to share their judgements loudly with others.
- ❑ In a further variation, there were two persons. One person was real participant and the other was confederate.

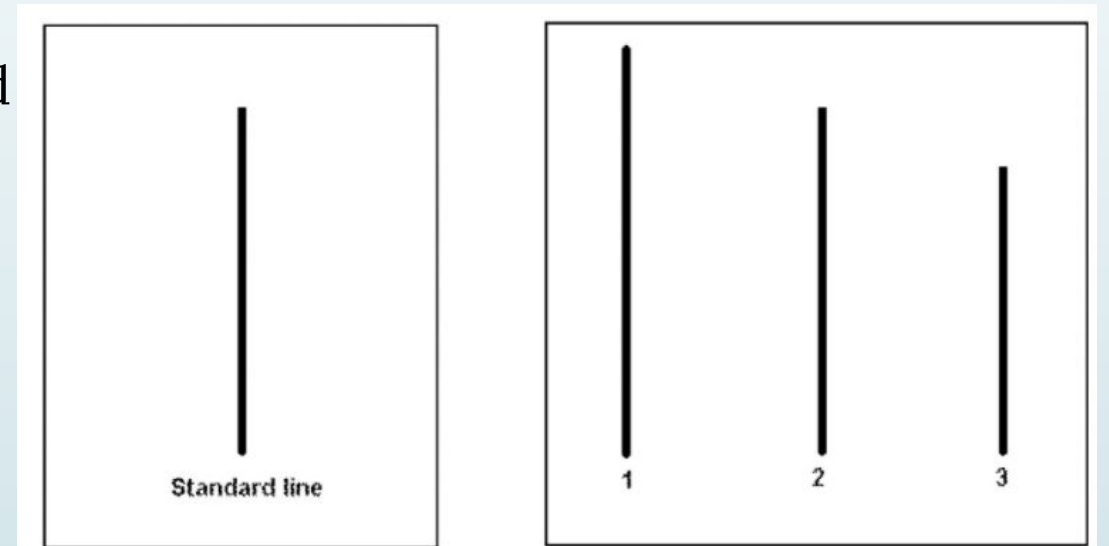
- 
- The confederates were asked to make his estimates consistently higher/lower than the real judgement.
  - By the end of the day, the responses of the real participants were similar to the confederates.

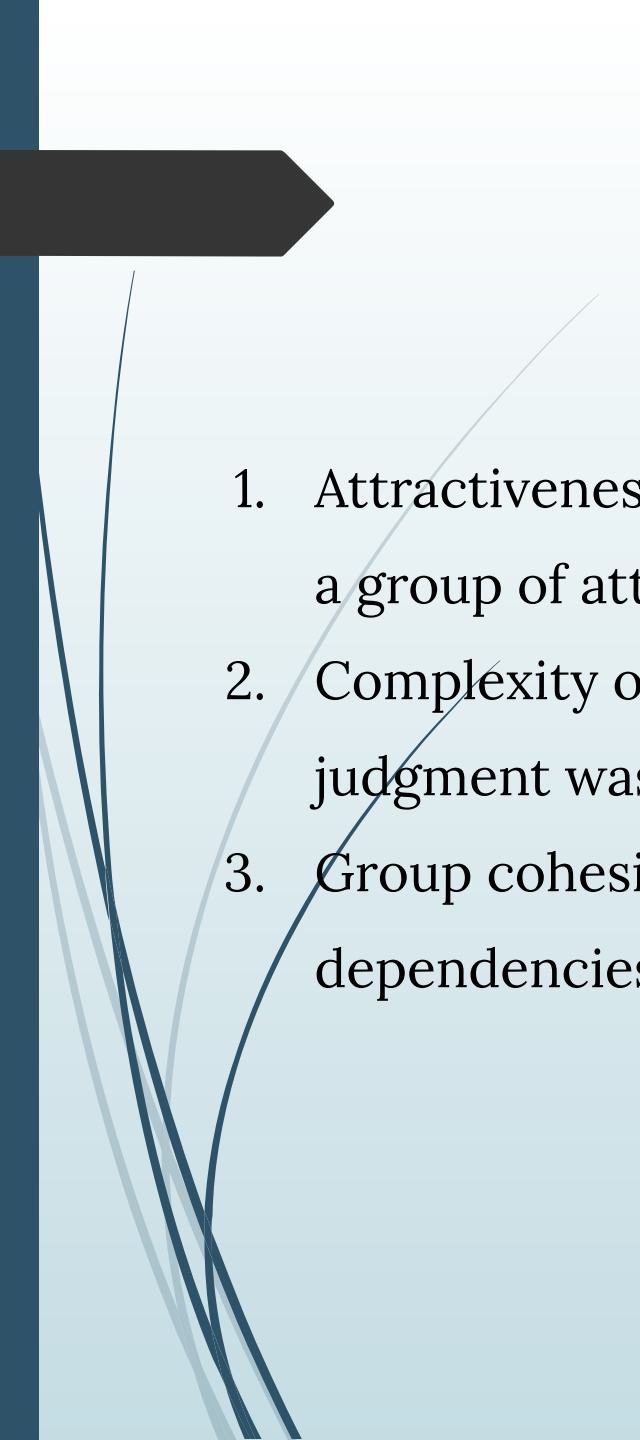
# Solomon Asch's Study

- Asch (1951) gave groups of seven or nine college students what appeared to be a test of perceptual judgment.
- Participants had to match the length of a line segment to comparison lines. Each subject saw a pair of cards set up in front of the room, similar to the ones below.
- In a group of nine, eight subjects were actually confederates of the experimenter. The experiment was rigged so that the genuine (naïve) subject was always the next-to-last to be called upon.



- The pressure of the group had a dramatic effect. Although people could pick the correct line 99% of the time when making the judgments by themselves, when they were put into the group of nine, 75% went along with an obviously incorrect group judgment at least once.



- 
1. Attractiveness of other members in the group (people tended to go along with a group of attractive people)
  2. Complexity or difficulty of the task (people were more likely to conform if the judgment was difficult).
  3. Group cohesiveness (people conformed more if friendships or mutual dependencies were set up beforehand).

# Why do people conform?

| Informational Influence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Normative Influence                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Conforming to others because the behaviour of others provides useful information.</li><li>● Tourists from a different country.</li><li>● difficulty of the task</li><li>● A person's confidence in the task.</li><li>● Faith on others/ group members.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Conforming to be liked or accepted by others.</li><li>● we want to gain social acceptance.</li></ul> |

# When do people conform?

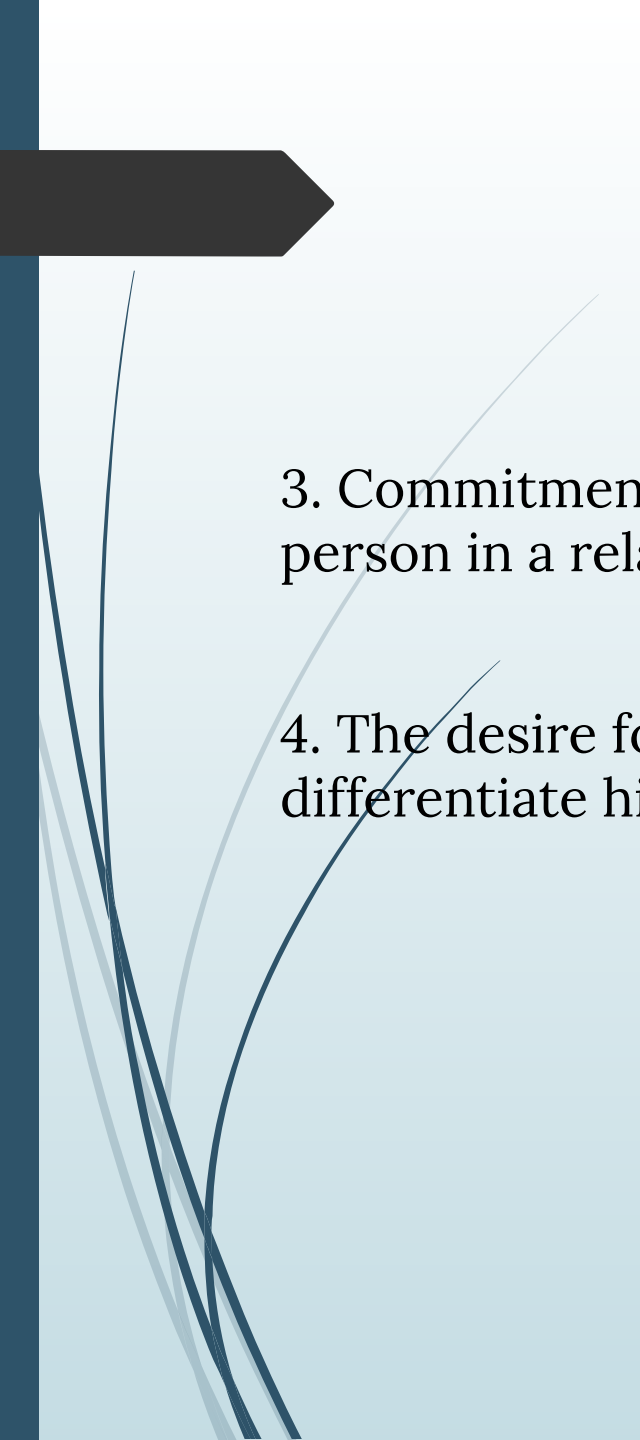
1. Group size: increases with the size of majority, at least up to a point.
2. Group unanimity: A person faced with a unanimous majority is under great pressure to conform.

If one person dissents, conformity drops.

This happens regardless of the position, influence, and/or charisma of the dissenter.

the amount of trust in the correctness of the majority decreases.

strengthens the confidence in one's own opinion which might have been different from the majority's opinion.



3. Commitment to the group: all the forces, positive/negative, that act to keep a person in a relationship/group.

4. The desire for individuation: A person's willingness to do things that publicly differentiate him/her from others or make him/her stand out.



# Problems with conformity

## 1. Political conformity:

Political participation can be influenced by the political preferences and political participation of peers.

Some mechanisms may encourage individuals to participate when they live in areas with other like-minded individuals, a phenomenon that we dub political conformity.



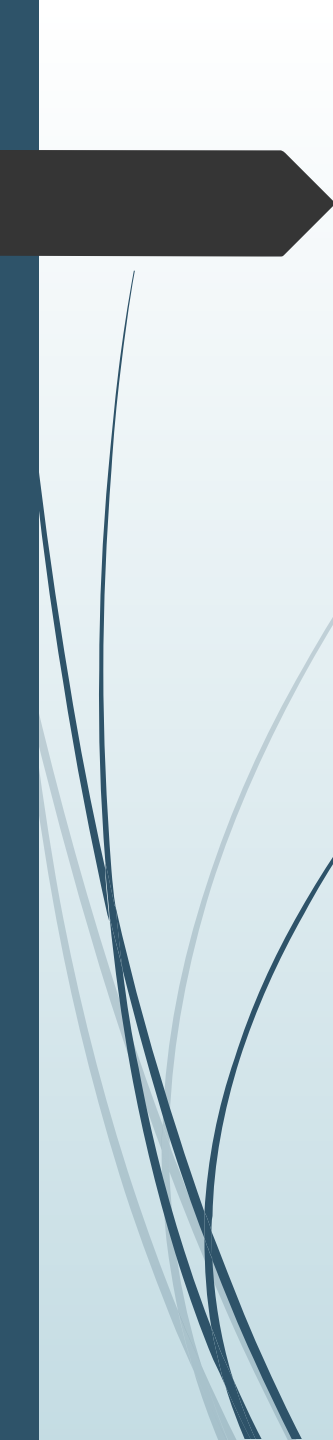


Hey, where  
is everyone  
going?

I don't know,  
but we better  
follow.

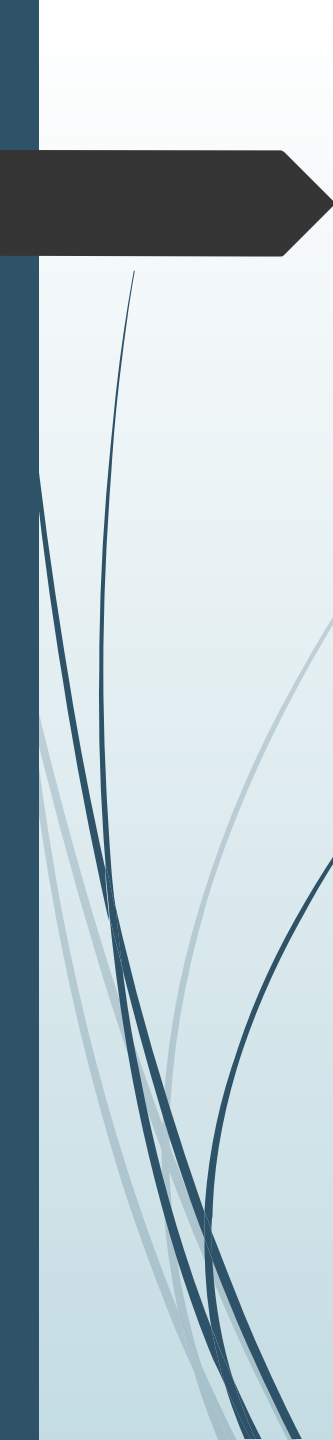
- Hair Bias:
- Becker (1963) argues that social groups label what is right and wrong or deviant based on the social norm of the majority
- The idea of Afrocentric hair being labeled as “bad hair” or “unprofessional,” or people with Afrocentric hairstyles being labeled as “angry Black women.”



- 
- ❑ Eurocentric standard of beauty that idealizes long, straight hair (Banks, 2000; Byrd & Tharps, 2014), Afrocentric hairstyles are often labeled unprofessional, unkempt, messy, or unacceptable.
  - ❑ Hewlin (2003) refers to as “facades of conformity.” When personal and organizational values conflict in the workplace, some employees may feel the need to suppress their personal values and behave in a way that is consistent with the organization, thereby masking their true self
  - ❑ They feel frustrated and resentful about having to appear in a way that is not authentic and at the expense of their self-esteem and potential cost/damage to their hair.

- ❑ Muscle dysmorphia:
- ❑ Type of body dysmorphic disorder
- ❑ Delusional belief that one's body is not enough muscular
- ❑ Conformity to masculine gender roles including dominance, confidence, sexual success, and physical and emotional self-control places men at risk for muscularity-oriented body dissatisfaction and disordered eating



- 
- ❑ Masculinization, does it happen in male-dominated industry?
  - ❑ Sheppard (1989) suggested that blending in through minimizing one's identity to feminine traits is one widely used strategy of "gender management" (Sheppard, 1989) among women in the male-dominated industry. Women might want to dress like men, talk like men, and show their conformity towards masculine identity.
  - ❑ Powell (2009) found strategies like behaving like boys, accepting gender discrimination, even taking an anti-woman approach among women engineers. In the present study, there was a continuous effort to disown the feminine identity.
  - ❑ Shifting towards round necks

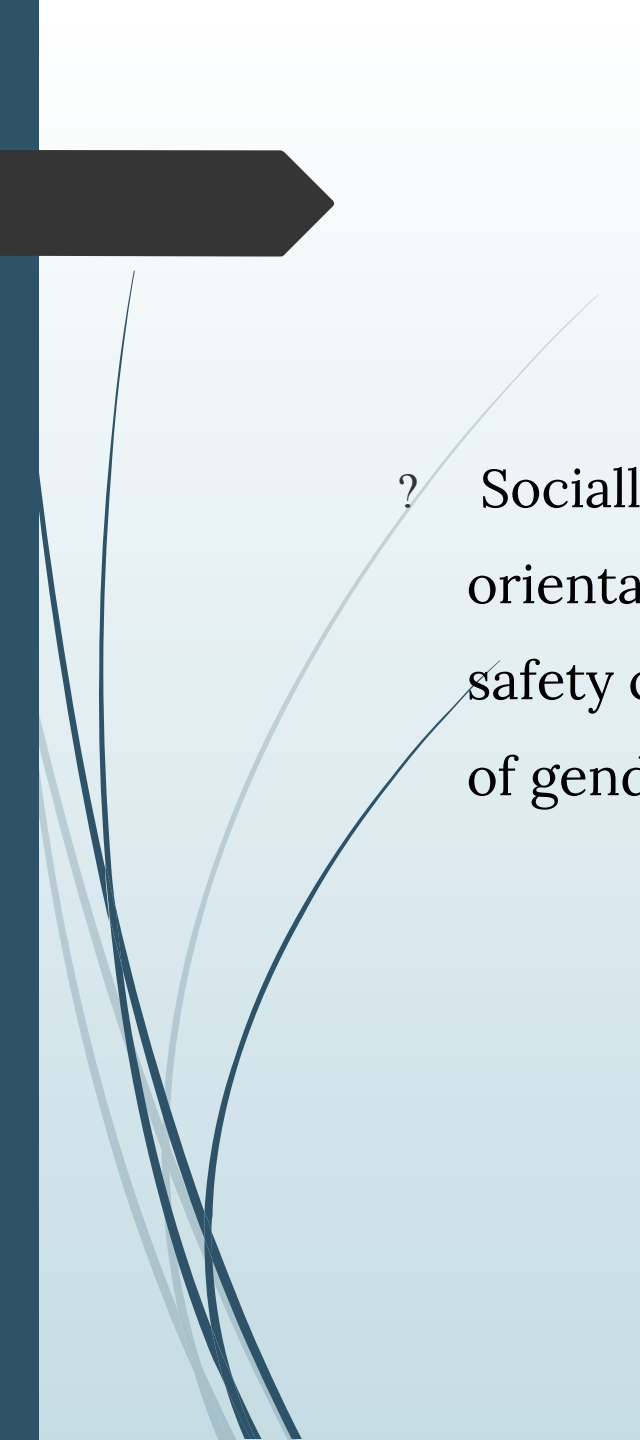




□ **The Glass Obstacle Course: Informal and Formal Barriers For Women Ph.D. Students in STEM Fields (Welde & Laursen, 2011)**

*“I definitely don’t feel comfortable acting like a woman. It took me a long time to feel comfortable to dress like a woman. At first I just dressed like a guy, basically, so that [I] could just blend in. But as I started to wear skirts and stuff like that, [I] definitely got the weird look occasionally”*

*“I looked relatively normal because I don’t dress as an engineer, and so they thought that was really strange. You know, I actually looked like a woman. \_She couldn’t have possibly done any science on her own,’ you know, \_She must have slept with someone to get it done.”*

- 
- ? Socially assigned gender nonconforming adolescents, regardless of sexual orientation or gender identity, are at greater risk of missed school due to safety concerns, and bullying, as compared with those who conform to norms of gender expression.

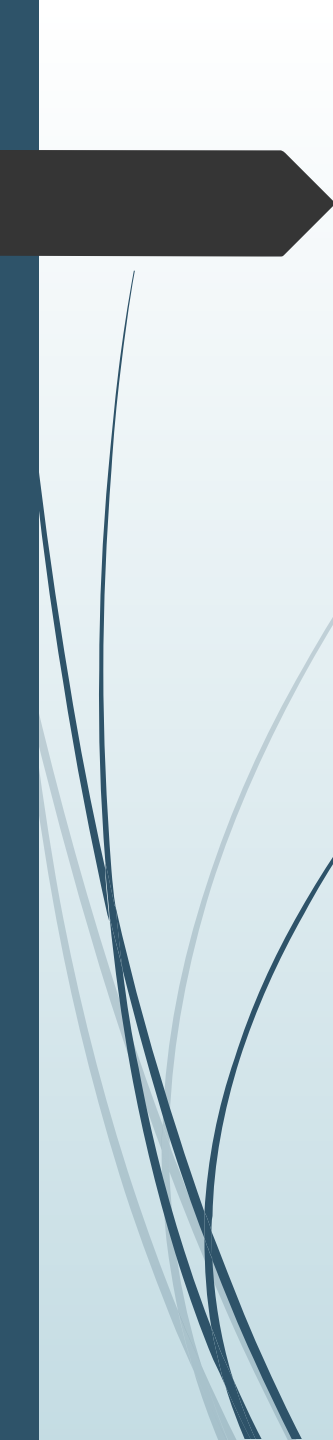




# Compliance

A form of social influence involving direct requests from one person to another.

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Base of Power       | Basis of power is...                                                                                                                                                   |
| Reward Power        | P's perception that O has the ability to mediate rewards for P                                                                                                         |
| Coercive Power      | P's perception that O has the ability to mediate punishments for P                                                                                                     |
| Legitimate Power    | Perception by P that O has a legitimate right (authority) to prescribe behaviour for P                                                                                 |
| Referent Power      | P's identification with O or the feeling of 'oneness' of P with O, or a desire for such an identity. O has attributes and abilities that are seen as charismatic by P. |
| Expert Power        | O has some special knowledge or expertise that makes P in some way perceive O as superior.                                                                             |
| Informational Power | O has information that P perceives as important.                                                                                                                       |

- 
- ☐ Friendship/liking
  - ☐ Commitment/consistency
  - ☐ Scarcity: In general, we value, and try to secure, outcomes or objects that are scarce or decreasing in availability.
  - ☐ Reciprocity: We are generally more willing to comply with a request from someone who has previously provided a favor or concession to us.
  - ☐ Social validation: We are generally more willing to comply with a request for some action if this action is consistent with what we believe people similar to ourselves are doing (or thinking).
  - ☐ Authority: In general, we are more willing to comply with requests from someone who holds legitimate authority—or simply appears to do so.



# Power of helplessness

- ☐ Norm of social responsibility: a norm dictating that we should help others who depend on us.
- ☐ We are more likely to follow the requests of a person who is helpless.
- ☐ Power of helplessness

# Mood and compliance

- ❑ Forgas (1998) predicted that we are more likely to comply to others when we are in a good mood as compared to when we are sad.
- ❑ although, it depends on the type of request.
- ❑ happy people ignore the way a request is worded, whether it is polite or rude.
- ❑ Sad people focus on the tone, words, and mood of the request.

# Compliance techniques

- **Foot-in-the-door technique:**

First, make a small request.

When the person complies, make another, larger request, make another larger request.

Freedman & Fraser (1966), women were asked to sign a petition by the committee of safe driving.

at the second phase, they were asked to put in their front yards a large, unattractive sign that says 'drive carefully'

55% of women who agreed to the first request complied to the second request as compared to 17% of women who never faced the first request.



## Why does it work?

1. Self-perception theory: the individual's self concept changes as a consequence of compliance.
2. The need to act consistently
3. when we agree to the first request, we become involved and committed to the issue.





- Door-in-the-Face Technique

First, make a really large request.

When the person denies, make a small request.

It works best when the small request is connected to the large request.



- The Low-Ball Technique

Obtain agreement with a modest request, then reveal hidden costs to the request.

Cialdini and colleagues (1978)'s experiment.

early morning experiment/experiment

25% agreed to participate in the early morning experiment as compared to 55% to the experiment when the time was not mentioned.

Once agreed, almost all the participants participated in the morning experiment.



- That's-Not-All Technique

Make a deal and then improve the offer

Add a bonus or reduce the price.



- The Pique Technique

Making an unusual request to disrupt the target's refusal script

Burger and colleagues (2008)

Passersby were asked for either a common amount of change or 37 cents. Participants who inquired about the unusual amount were given either a specific or an uninformative reason.



# Reactance theory

- ☐ When our sense of freedom is threatened, we often restore it by refusing to comply.
- ☐ Very strongly worded message might reduce the compliance



# Things to reflect on

1. The Good, bad, and ugly of conformity and compliance
2. real life applications of the concepts